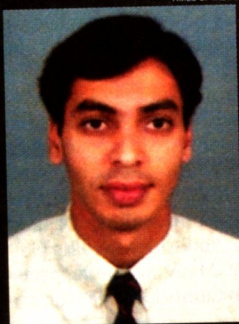


Doctor in Crime



PLOTTER DOWN UNDER? Haneef's (left) mother Qurrathlain and sister Surayya at their home in Bangalore



in Arms



SIBLING SYNDICATE

- Born in 1981. Younger brother of Kafeel. Completes schooling in Indian Embassy School Damam, Saudi Arabia.
- Enrolls in Ambedkar Medical College in 1998. Not a very bright student. Takes two extra years to complete the course by 2004.
- Goes to UK in 2004. Works at Halton Hospital, Cheshire, with Haneef in Liverpool where he is arrested. Visits brother in Cambridge.



job market. The project, 'Excelling Quality Through Testing, R&D and Training', explained why Indian companies did not pay enough attention to quality control. As team leader and co-ordinator, he put a plan of action in place, doing everything from arranging permissions to collecting data on various firms in the city, helping the students with data collection on training

and R&D, to acquainting them with the bus routes of Bangalore. The students, who worked together in two-member teams, met every evening for a month at one of the companies. A fiercely-focused Kafeel reviewed the day's work and planned the next day.

"It was quite a time," recalls Thakuria, who now works as a project leader with HP in Bangalore. Yet, there

was an invisible line. The team members, all out-of-towners, were never invited to 'Kausar', the Ahmeds' home. The team meetings were friendly, but strictly connected to studies. The project dwelt on survey data and results of quality control in India. "Indian companies must wake up to quality control in every field," the report urged. "It was nicely researched and had an intelligent analysis and conclusion," says project guide Professor Ramesh.

The project gave the classmates the only brief glimpse of the team leader who drifted away after graduation in 2000. He did not register to be part of the college's globe-spanning alumni network. In 2001, Kafeel joined Queen's University in Belfast to study aeronautical engineering for three years. His younger brother Sabeel, 26, an average student, was already studying medicine at the Ambedkar Medical College. He was joined by Haneef Mohammed, also 26, a second cousin of the Ahmeds. After graduating from medical school in 2004, Sabeel and Haneef worked in the UK, while Kafeel took up a research post at Anglia Ruskin University in Cambridge for a doctorate in computation fluid dynamics (CFD), a branch of fluid mechanics that uses numerical methods and algorithms to solve problems involving fluid flows.

Kafeel showed a keen interest in aerodynamic design, electronic maps and inkjet cartridges, producing a seminal paper on the latter subject, which earned him a lot of praise in the university's annual report. He later joined a team of researchers in designing an inkjet to print a tactile map for the blind.

In 2004, he shared a flat with an unnamed local activist from Hizb-ut-Tahrir, a radical group banned in Britain, who, in turn, introduced him to Bilal. This was the turning point and it was here that Kafeel came under the sway of Bilal's radical Islamic bent. Bilal, who hailed from an elite Sunni Muslim family under the Saddam Hussein regime, was a devout follower of Wahhabi Islam. Soon, Kafeel began looking up to the Iraqi doctor who had moved to Cambridge in 2001. The duo became best friends. Sabeel and Haneef, who were working together at